Figurative Language

Year 4 Pt 2 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: Identify the simile: "The kitten was as fluffy as a cloud."
Method & answer: as fluffy as a cloud --- it compares the kitten to a cloud using "as...as".

Standard: Identify the metaphor and explain what it suggests: "The classroom was a zoo."
Method & answer: The classroom was a zoo --- it suggests the classroom was extremely noisy, chaotic and wild, without using "like" or "as".

Advanced: Identify the personification and explain its effect: "The wind whispered secrets through the trees."
Method & answer: The wind whispered --- it gives the wind a human ability (whispering), creating a mysterious, gentle atmosphere.

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Identify the simile: "Her smile was as bright as the sun."

2. Identify the alliteration: "The slippery snake slithered silently."

3. Which figurative device is used in 'The stars were diamonds in the sky'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

4. Identify the personification: "The old house groaned in the wind."

5. Identify the simile: "He ran like a cheetah."

6. Identify the alliteration: "Busy bees buzzed by."

7. Select ALL the sentences below that use a METAPHOR: A) Time is money. B) The playground was a battlefield. C) He ran like a cheetah. D) The stars were diamonds in the sky. E) Her voice was like music.

8. Identify the personification: "The leaves danced across the ground."

9. Identify the simile: "The ice was as cold as steel."

10. Identify the alliteration: "Wild winds whipped the waves."

11. Which figurative device is used in 'The playground was a battlefield'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

12. Which figurative device is used in 'The sun smiled down on the village'? A) simile B) metaphor C) personification D) alliteration

13. Identify the simile: "Her voice was like music."

14. Identify the alliteration: "Sandy sat silently by the sea."

15. Is 'The car was as fast as lightning' a simile or a metaphor? A) Simile — it uses 'as...as' to compare B) Metaphor — it says the car IS lightning C) Personification D) Alliteration

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain the effect of this simile: "The crowd roared like a pack of lions."

6. Explain the effect of this simile: "The old man's hands were like dry leaves."

11. Which letters are repeated in this alliteration: 'The thunder thumped and the rain rattled the

roof'? A) th and r B) t and d C) n and l D) o and u

2. Write a metaphor to describe a very angry teacher.

7. Is 'Her eyes sparkled like diamonds' a simile or a metaphor? A) Simile — it uses 'like' B) Metaphor — it says her eyes ARE diamonds C) Personification D) Alliteration

12. Explain the difference between a simile and a metaphor, using one example of each.

3. Explain the effect of this personification: "The fire devoured the forest."

8. Explain the effect of this metaphor: "The city never sleeps."

13. Write a simile to describe someone running very fast.

4. Is 'The moon was a silver coin in the sky' a simile or a metaphor? A) Simile — it uses 'like' or 'as' B) Metaphor — it says the moon WAS a coin, with no 'like' or 'as' C) Personification D) Alliteration

9. Write a personification sentence about the sea.

14. Explain the effect of this personification: "The clock's hands raced towards midnight."

5. Write an alliterative phrase to describe the wind.

10. Select ALL the sentences below that are examples of PERSONIFICATION: A) The snow fell softly. B) The wind whispered through the trees. C) Opportunity knocked at his door. D) The car was as fast as lightning. E) The clock's hands raced towards midnight.

15. Is 'Opportunity knocked at his door' a simile, metaphor or personification? A) Simile B) Metaphor C) Personification — opportunity is given the human action of knocking D) Alliteration

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain what an extended metaphor is, then identify one across these two sentences: "The classroom was a battlefield. Pencils were weapons, and silence was the enemy."

6. Select ALL the words below from 'The soldiers marched, steady and silent, into the storm' that contribute to the alliteration: A) soldiers B) steady C) silent D) storm E) marched

11. In 'The wind howled like a wolf', which device is used, and why? A) Simile — it compares the wind's sound to a wolf using 'like'; true personification would give the wind a human/animal action directly, without a comparison word B) Personification — it gives the wind a human action directly C) Metaphor — it says the wind IS a wolf D) Alliteration

2. Why does 'He was a lion, but she was a stubborn mule' weaken the writing? A) It uses two unrelated animal comparisons in one sentence, creating a confusing, clashing image B) It has no figurative language at all C) It is too short D) It uses a simile instead of a metaphor

7. Why is the metaphor 'Her words were daggers' more powerful than the simile 'Her words were like daggers'? A) A metaphor makes a direct, bold claim that feels more immediate and forceful, while a simile softens the comparison by admitting it is only a comparison B) Metaphors are always shorter C)

12. Write an original metaphor (not a cliché) to describe a difficult exam, and explain the feeling it captures.

Similes are never effective D) There is no real difference

3. Explain why "as brave as a lion" is considered a cliché, and suggest a more original simile with the same meaning.

8. What type of figurative language is used in 'The machine coughed, spluttered, and finally roared to life'? A) Simile B) Onomatopoeia and personification, making the machine seem almost human C) Alliteration D) Rhyme

13. Explain why "The fog crept in like a thief" combines a simile with an implied personification, and explain the effect.

4. Identify the personification in this sentence and explain its effect in creating atmosphere: "Shadows crept across the abandoned house, and the windows stared blankly into the night."

9. Explain why using too many similes in one paragraph can weaken writing, using this example: "She was as quiet as a mouse, as pale as a ghost, and as still as a statue."

14. Identify the alliteration and explain how the sound of the words matches their meaning: "The gentle giant grumbled and groaned."

5. Explain the difference in effect between saying "The rain fell hard" and using the metaphor "The sky wept".

10. Identify the personification and explain what mood it creates: "Despair wrapped its cold fingers around the village."

15. Explain why writers sometimes choose personification over a literal description, using this example: "The old bridge groaned under the weight of the lorry."